

GERALD HUBER
Director

DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & SOCIAL SERVICES

Medical Services Division

BRYN MUMMA, MD, MAS
EMS Agency Medical Director

EMERGENCY SERVICES BUREAU
355 Tuolumne Street,
Suite 2400, MS 20-240
Vallejo, CA 94590



SOLANO
COUNTY

TED SELBY
EMS Agency Administrator

(707) 784-8155
www.solanocounty.com

POLICY MEMORANDUM 3303

Effective Date: July 1, 2017

Review Date: July 1, 2019

REVIEWED/APPROVED BY:

A blue ink signature of Bryn Mumma.

BRYN MUMMA, MD, MAS, EMS AGENCY MEDICAL DIRECTOR

A blue ink signature of Ted Selby.

TED SELBY, EMS AGENCY ADMINISTRATOR

**SUBJECT: EMERGENCY MEDICAL TECHNICIAN (EMT) LOCAL OPTIONAL
SCOPE OF PRACTICE PROVIDER AUTHORIZATION**

AUTHORITY:

California Code of Regulations (CCR), Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 2, Article 4, Section 100079, Article 5, Sections 100080 and 100081, and Article 6, Section 100083

PURPOSE:

To establish requirements and standards for medical control so an Emergency Medical Services (EMS) provider within Solano County may utilize the EMT Local Optional Scope of Practice.

I. EMT Local Optional Scope of Practice

- A. The following BLS Local Optional Scope of Practice skills are authorized for use within Solano County for an EMT that is employed with a Solano County EMS provider:
 - 1. Utilization of a perilaryngeal airway.
 - a. The preferred perilaryngeal airway for Solano County is the King Airway.
- B. In order for an EMT to be eligible to be accredited to use a perilaryngeal airway, the training requirements stated in Solano County EMS Policy 6300, EMT Scope of Practice, must be met and documentation submitted to Solano County EMS upon initial training and EMT recertification.

II. EMT Local Optional Scope of Practice Service Provider Requirements

- A. If an EMS Provider within Solano County wishes to utilize the Local Optional EMT Scope of Practice skill(s), the EMS provider must submit the following documentation prior to utilization of the skills(s):
1. A letter of intent to provide EMT Local Optional Scope of Practice skills signed by a chief officer, expressing willingness to abide by all Solano County EMS Agency policies, protocols, and program requirements.
 2. Identification of the Local Optional skill(s) being requested for utilization.
 3. A description of the geographical area in which the Local Optional skill(s) will be utilized.
 4. Designation of an EMT Local Optional Scope of Practice Medical Director and a Program Coordinator/Lead Instructor.
 - a. The Program Coordinator/Lead Instructor shall be a physician, Registered Nurse (RN), physician assistant, or Paramedic licensed in California.
 5. A description of the plans for initial accreditation and reaccreditation training for the Local Optional skill(s) to be utilized including, but not limited to, written exams, skills demonstration, equipment, and recurring skills competency.
 - a. The training requirements for the utilization of a perilyngeal airway are included in Policy 6300, EMT Scope of Practice, Section III.
 - b. Refer to Policy 6608, Advanced Airway Management, Section II for the procedure for utilization of the King Airway.

III. Responsibilities of the EMT Local Optional Scope of Practice Program Coordinator

- A. The responsibilities of the EMT Local Optional Scope of Practice Program Coordinator are as follows:
1. Provide the Solano County EMS Agency with a description of the data collection methodology, which shall also include the effectiveness of the use of the Local Optional skill(s).
 2. Submit to the Solano EMS Agency the Patient Care Report (PCR) when a Local Optional skill is used within 72 hours after the incident.
 3. Perform a monthly review of any Local Optional skill(s) that was used in the prior month.
 4. Provide an annual update by the end of January to Solano County EMS that includes:
 - a. A list of all EMTs that are currently accredited to use Local Optional skills;
 - b. Any changes to program personnel;

- c. Any changes to training curriculum.
- 5. Report any unusual events or detrimental outcomes when utilizing a Local Optional skill by submitting a Field Advisory Report (FAR) in compliance with Solano County EMS Policy 6100.

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GERALD HUBER
Director

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355 Tuolumne Street,
Suite 2400, MS 20-240
Vallejo, CA 94590

DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & SOCIAL SERVICES

Public Health Division



**SOLANO
COUNTY**

PRANAV SHETTY, MD, MPH
EMS Agency Medical Director

BENJAMIN GAMMON, EMT-P
EMS Agency Administrator

(707) 784-8155
www.solanocounty.com

POLICY MEMORANDUM 3304

Implementation Date: May 21, 2023

Review Date: March 1, 2025

REVIEWED/APPROVED BY:

A blue ink signature of Pranav Shetty, MD, MPH.

PRANAV SHETTY, MD, MPH, EMS AGENCY MEDICAL DIRECTOR

A blue ink signature of Benjamin Gammon, EMT-P.

BENJAMIN GAMMON, EMT-P, EMS AGENCY ADMINISTRATOR

**SUBJECT: ADVANCED LIFE SUPPORT (ALS) PARAMEDIC INTERFACILITY
TRANSFER (IFT) OPTIONAL SKILLS PROVIDER AGENCY
APPROVAL, REQUIREMENTS, AND RESPONSIBILITIES**

AUTHORITY: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, Sections 1798.200, 1798.206,
1798.214, 1797.218, 1797.220, 1798.2, 1798.170, and 1798.172
California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Chapter 4, Article 1, Section
100145

I. PURPOSE:

- A. To establish the provider agency application and approval process for utilization of any of the following Paramedic IFT optional skills and to establish requirements and responsibilities of the Solano County EMS authorized Paramedic IFT optional skills provider:
1. Monitoring of magnesium sulfate, nitroglycerin (NTG), heparin, and/or amiodarone infusions.
 2. Monitoring of blood transfusions.
 3. Utilization of automatic transport ventilators (ATV).

II. PROVIDER AUTHORIZATION AND APPLICATION PROCESS

- A. Only the Solano County ALS Exclusive Operating Area (EOA) Provider may be authorized to utilize Paramedic IFT optional skills.
- B. Only appropriately trained Paramedics employed by the ALS EOA Provider may utilize Paramedic IFT optional skills.
- C. The ALS EOA provider shall submit a proposal to the EMS Agency to initiate Paramedic IFT optional skills to include the following:
 - 1. A letter of intent to utilize paramedic IFT optional skills including the list of skills to be utilized.
 - 2. The proposed paramedic IFT optional skills program implementation date and anticipated IFT optional skills utilization frequency/volume.
 - 3. The number of personnel to be trained to use the IFT optional skills.
 - 4. A description of the ALS EOA provider's IFT optional skills training program to consist of the following:
 - a. Monitoring of magnesium sulfate, NTG, heparin, and/or amiodarone infusions – minimum of two hours.
 - b. Monitoring of blood transfusions – minimum of two hours
 - c. Utilization of ATVs – minimum of two hours
 - d. CV/resume of the proposed physician or Registered Nurse (RN) that will be the lead instructor for the training course.
 - i. A Paramedic may be used for a lead instructor but a separate letter will need to be included as to the reason to use a Paramedic is necessary.
 - e. Copies of the skills exam sheets and written examination for course completion.
 - 5. The ALS EOA provider's IFT optional skills utilization policies and procedures, which shall, at a minimum, address the following:
 - a. Paramedic personnel shall obtain a copy of the transferring physician's orders and attach them to the electronic Patient Care Report (ePCR).
 - b. Patients on any infusion shall have vital signs monitored and documented every 15 minutes.
 - c. Patients with blood transfusions shall have vital signs monitored and documented every 15 minutes and if there is any change in status or change in infusion rate.
 - d. Patients on ATVs shall have vital signs monitored and documented every 15 minutes and if there is any change in status or adjustment of the ATV settings.

6. A description of the ALS EOA provider's IFT optional skills utilization QI process.
 - a. The ALS EOA provider shall audit 100% of IFT optional skills utilization to assess compliance with physician orders and Solano County EMS policies.
- D. Approval or disapproval of the program will be made in writing within 30 days of receipt of the proposal.
- E. Any unusual occurrence while utilizing the IFT optional skills will be submitted using a Field Advisory Report (FAR).
- F. The ALS EOA provider shall maintain a roster of the Paramedics approved to utilize the IFT optional skills and provide it upon request to Solano County EMS.

Solano County Health & Social Services Department

Mental Health Services
Public Health Services
Substance Abuse Services
Older & Disabled Adult Services



Eligibility Services
Employment Services
Children's Services
Administrative Services

Ann Edwards, Director

Aaron E. Bair, MD, MSc
EMS Agency Medical Director

EMERGENCY SERVICES BUREAU
275 Beck Avenue MS 5-240
Fairfield, Ca. 94533
(707) 784-8155 FAX (707) 421-6682
www.solanocounty.com

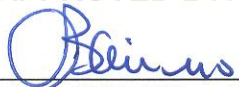
Ted Selby
Emergency Services Bureau Chief

POLICY MEMORANDUM 3310

Implementation Date: 12/01/13

Release Date: 10/14/13

REVIEWED/APPROVED BY:



AARON E. BAIR, MD, MSc, EMS AGENCY MEDICAL DIRECTOR



TED SELBY, EMS AGENCY ADMINISTRATOR

SUBJECT: FIRELINE EMERGENCY MEDICAL PARAMEDIC (FEMP) AND
FIRELINE EMERGENCY MEDICAL TECHNICIAN (FEMT)

AUTHORITY: CALIFORNIA HEALTH & SAFETY CODE, DIVISION 2.5, 1797.204, 1797.220, and 1798 (a)(b); California Code of Regulations, Division 9, Sections 100165 and 100167

PURPOSE/POLICY: To allow Solano County accredited Paramedics or Emergency Medical Technicians (EMT) to function as FIRELINE Emergency Medical Paramedics (FEMP) or FIRELINE Emergency Medical Technicians (FEMT) in the event of a request made through the California fire mutual aid system.

I. Fire Line Emergency Medical Technician (FEMT) or Fire Line Emergency Medical Paramedic (FEMP)

A. Qualifications:

1. Must be a Solano County accredited Emergency Medical Technician or Paramedic.
 - a) The EMT or Paramedic must be affiliated with and deployed through a Solano County Fire Agency.

- b) Proposed EMT(s) and/or Paramedic(s) must be approved by the Solano County California Incident Command Certification System (CICCS) Committee through the Solano County Fire Chiefs Association.
 - c) The Solano County CICCS Mutual Aid Area Coordinator will submit a list to the EMS Agency of those individuals who are qualified to act as FEMT or FEMP by May 31 of each calendar year (before the fire season).
 2. Must comply with the required training listed in FireScope Incident Command System Position Manual: Fireline Emergency Medical Technician-Paramedic FEMP ICS 223-11 dated May 16, 2011. Fire Department(s) may develop policy, procedure, and protocols associated with FEMT/FEMP. In the event multiple policies exist, the more stringent requirements/qualifications will supersede those in this policy.
 3. FEMT/FEMP Scope of practice will be limited to the most current Solano County Basic Life Support (BLS) or Advanced Life Support (ALS) Protocols.
- B. FEMT/FEMP's Home Fire Agency Requirements:
 1. Ensure the FEMT/FEMP use the most current Solano County BLS and ALS Treatment Protocols.
 2. Provide appropriate quality improvement and supervision.
 3. Report to Solano County EMS any adverse incident(s) that the FEMT/FEMP is involved in, or a party to, using a Field Advisory Report (FAR).
 4. Maintain documentation of compliance with this policy. The FEMT/FEMP's home fire agency may be subject to periodic review of documentation. Compliance documentation (e. g. records of completion of required training, proof of affiliation with a Solano County Fire Agency, etc.) must be maintained on file for 36 months.
- C. Requirement Equipment:
 - At a minimum, the approved equipment listed in attachments A and B must be available as necessary.
- D. Treatment Procedures and Documentation:
 1. The FEMT/FEMP will follow and treat patients using the most current Solano County BLS or ALS Protocols.
 2. The FEMT/FEMP will complete and provide to the EMS Agency a Patient Care Report (PCR) in accordance with Solano County Policies.
 3. The FEMT/FEMP will follow Solano County's Policy for Refusal of Medical Assistance (RMA).

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Attachment A

BLS Equipment List

- Airways – Oral / Nasal Pharyngeal Kit (minimum quantity 1)
- Bag Valve Mask (1)
- Bandage, Sterile 4 X 4 (6)
- Bandage, Triangular (2)
- Biohazard Bag (2)
- Cervical Collar, Adjustable (1)
- Coban Wraps / Ace Bandage (2 ea.)
- Cold Pack (3)
- Dextrose (1)
- Dressing, Multi-Trauma (4)
- Exam Gloves
- Kerlix, Kling, 4.5 Sterile (2)
- Pen Light (1)
- Petroleum Dressing (2)
- Sheet, Burn or equivalent (2)
- Sphygmomanometer (1)
- Splint, Moldable
- Stethoscope (1)
- Suction, Manual Device (1)
- Tape, 1 inch, Cloth (2 rolls)
- Thermometer, Digital (1)
- Triangular Dressing with Pin (2)
- Triage Tags (6)

Attachment B

ALS Equipment List

ALS Airway Equipment:

- Endotracheal Intubation Equipment (cuffed endotracheal tubes, 2 each of 7.0, 7.5, 8.0 and 1 each of 6.0, 6.5; un-cuffed endotracheal tubes, 1 each of 2.5, 3.0, 3.5, 4.0, 4.5, 5.0 and 5.5); adult straight # 4 blade; adult curved # 3 blade; infant straight # 1 blade; infant curved # 2 blade; stylette and handle
- Rescue Airway (minimum quantity 1) such as a King or Combi-tube
- ETT Restraint (1)
- End Tidal CO₂ Detector
- Needle Thoracostomy Kit (1)

IV/Medication Administration Supplies:

- 1 ml TB syringe (2)
- 10 ml Syringe (2)
- 14 ga. IV Catheter (2)
- 16 ga. IV Catheter (2)
- 18 ga. IV Catheter (2)
- 18 ga. Needle (4)
- 20 ga. IV Catheter (2)
- 25 ga. Needle (2)
- Alcohol Preps (6)
- Betadine Swabs (4)
- Glucometer Test Strips (4)
- IV Administration Set-Macro-Drip (2)
- Lancet (4)
- Razor (1)
- Tourniquet (2)
- Transpore Tape (1)
- Venaguard (2)

Miscellaneous:

- Sharps Container (1)
- PCR (6)
- RMA Forms (3)
- Triage Tags (6)

Biomedical Equipment:

- AED/SAD Patches or Monitor Leads and Patches (2)
- Compact AED/SAD or EKG Monitor (waveform display preferred) (1)
- Glucometer (1)
- Pulse Oximeter (1)

Medications:

- Aerosolized Beta 2 Specific Bronchodilator (Albuterol; 0.84% solution) (4 for nebulization)
- Aspirin – Chewable (325 mg) (1 bottle)
- Atropine Injectable – 1.0 mg (2)
- Dextrose 50% Injectable 25 Gram Pre-Load (1)
- Diphenhydramine Injectable 50 mg (4)
- Epinephrine Injectable 1:1,000 1mg (4)
- Epinephrine Injectable 1:10,000 1mg (2)
- Glucagon 1mg/unit (1)
- Lidocaine Injectable 100mg (2)
- Normal Saline 0.9 % IV 1,000 ml – can be configured into two 500 ml bags or four 250 ml bags
- Nitroglycerin 0.4mg tablet or spray (1)
- Morphine Sulfate 10mg/ml (2) }
- Versed 5mg/2ml (2) }

And appropriate double locking device
to carry approved narcotics.

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BRYN MUMMA, MD, MAS
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(707) 784-8155
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POLICY MEMORANDUM 3400

Implementation Date: September 28, 2008

Revised Date: August 1, 2022

Review Date: August 1, 2024

REVIEWED/APPROVED BY:

A blue ink signature of PrNAV Shetty, MD, MPH, EMS Agency Medical Director.

PRANAV SHETTY, MD, MPH, EMS AGENCY MEDICAL DIRECTOR

A blue ink signature of Benjamin Gammon, EMT-P, Interim EMS Agency Administrator.

BENJAMIN GAMMON, EMT-P, INTERIM EMS AGENCY ADMINISTRATOR

SUBJECT: PARAMEDIC ACCREDITATION/REACCREDITATION PROCESS

AUTHORITY: California Code of Regulations Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, Article 1, Section 100142 and Article 2, Section 100146 and Article 5, Section 100165, 100166 California Health & Safety Code Division 2.5, §1797.7, 1797.84, 1797.178, 1797.185, 1797.194, 1797.214, & 1797.220

PURPOSE/POLICY:

Accreditation is a process by which the Solano County Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Agency and its Medical Director can be assured that all Paramedics functioning in the EMS system are oriented to local policies, procedures, and EMS system features as well as possess those skills necessary to perform any optional scope of practice skills and procedures currently being used in Solano County.

Nothing in this policy prohibits an employer from imposing stricter requirements for the employment or orientation of Paramedic personnel.

I. INITIAL ACCREDITATION

- A. To be eligible for accreditation in Solano County, an individual must:
 - 1. Provide evidence of possession of a valid California Statewide Paramedic license which is current. State Licensure means that the individual has met specified training and education standards and has been deemed competent

to practice throughout the State of California in the Paramedic scope of practice, as defined in Title 22 of the California Code of Regulations (CCR).

2. Provide proof of employment with an authorized Solano County Advanced Life Support (ALS) Provider.
 - a. A Paramedic may become accredited as a Paramedic in Solano County if they are a volunteer firefighter for an authorized Solano County ALS Provider. The ALS fire department employing the Volunteer Firefighter/Paramedic must provide employment verification.
3. Provide evidence of a valid, current certification card in the following:
 - a. Basic Life Support (BLS) Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation (CPR) for Healthcare Provider or equivalent; **and**
 - b. Advanced Cardiac Life Support (ACLS) card issued in accordance with the guidelines of the Journal of the American Medical Association (JAMA); **and**
 - c. Pediatric Advanced Life Support (PALS) **OR** Pediatric Education for Prehospital Professionals (PEPP); **and**
 - d. Prehospital Trauma Life Support (PHTLS) **OR** Basic Trauma Life Support (BTLS) **OR** International Trauma Life Support (ITLS).
4. Apply to Solano County EMS Agency. Application includes the following:
 - a. Completion of an on-line application form; and
 - b. Check or money order payable to "Solano County EMS" for the amount specified in Solano County EMS Policy Memo #3000.
5. Attend an EMS Agency orientation not to exceed eight (8) classroom hours and submit orientation forms as specified in Solano County Policy 3600.
6. An application that has not had any activity in 120 days from creation will be considered abandoned. If the application is abandoned, the Paramedic must restart the accreditation process.

B. EMS Agency Orientation

1. Paramedics will be oriented to the local EMS system including EMS Agency organization, function, staff, policies, procedures, treatment protocols, base and receiving hospital protocols, specialty care center protocols, EMS Quarterly Meeting requirements, and other unique system features.
2. The orientation should not repeat items within the Paramedic scope of practice which are already covered in the State's written and skills examinations.
3. The orientation may not exceed eight (8) hours, excluding any necessary testing in the optional scope of practice.
4. The orientation shall be completed within 120 days of receipt of a completed application.

C. Pre-Accreditation Field Evaluation

1. The purpose of the field evaluation is to validate that the applicant is knowledgeable to begin functioning under local policies and protocols.

2. The performance of skills and procedures by the accreditation applicant will be done in the presence of a field preceptor designated by the Solano County EMS Agency. Although the applicant may be licensed as a Paramedic in California, the preceptor has the ultimate responsibility for patient care rendered by the Paramedic during the evaluation period.
3. It is the responsibility of the field preceptor to determine if the applicant is ready to begin functioning within Solano County; practicing optional scope in accordance with local policies and procedures.
4. The pre-accreditation field evaluation is limited to a minimum of five (5) but no more than ten (10) ALS calls. An ALS call is defined as at least one (1) invasive skill performed or one (1) medication administered.
 - a. This requirement may be waived by providing documentation of a minimum of five (5) but no more than ten (10) ALS calls during a Paramedic education program field internship with a Solano County ALS Provider within the previous six (6) months.
5. The EMS Medical Director, or EMS Agency designee, shall evaluate the calls submitted to the EMS Agency to ensure that EMS Agency policy and protocol were followed and to evaluate the quality of patient care given. If it is demonstrated in this evaluation that the Paramedic applicant did not perform treatment as outlined in policy/protocol, the Paramedic applicant may be required to report back to his preceptor for further instruction or calls. The call documentation will also be submitted back to the Paramedic's precepting provider for further Quality Improvement review.
6. The EMS Medical Director shall evaluate any Paramedic applicant who fails to successfully complete the field evaluation and may recommend further evaluation or training. If during the field evaluation, the applicant's proficiency in the scope of practice comes into question, then the qualification of the individual to hold a license becomes an issue and the Solano County EMS Agency shall evaluate the situation for appropriate action including, but not limited to, forwarding to the State EMS Authority for further review.

D. Accreditation Procedure

1. Upon completion of an application, verification of employment with a Solano County ALS provider, submission of required documentation, and issuance of an "A-Number" identifier, the licensed Paramedic may practice the Solano County EMS scope of Paramedic practice as a second Paramedic on a unit. A designated preceptor need not be present at this time.
2. After issuance of the "A-Number" identifier, the Paramedic applicant may only utilize the optional scope of practice in the presence of a Solano County Designated Paramedic Preceptor during the pre-accreditation field evaluation.
3. The applicant may work as a single Paramedic once the pre-accreditation field evaluation, base hospital orientation, and provider employer orientations have been completed and reviewed by the EMS Agency and a Solano County Paramedic Number has been issued.

4. The applicant shall complete the EMS Agency orientation within 120 days of initiating the accreditation process.
 - a. If a Paramedic is issued a Solano County Paramedic Number prior to attending the EMS Agency orientation and fails to attend the next scheduled orientation, the Paramedic will be issued a mandatory notice to attend the next orientation. If the Paramedic fails to attend a second scheduled orientation, the Paramedic's accreditation will be suspended until the orientation until the orientation is attended.
 - b. If the EMS Agency cancels an EMS Agency orientation Paramedics will not be penalized.
5. An applicant who fails to complete the accreditation process may not practice as a Paramedic in Solano County.
6. The local EMS Agency accredits individuals to practice in Solano County. Accreditation to practice shall be continuous if the State of California Paramedic license is maintained and local requirements are met.
7. Accreditation is indicated by the issuance of a Solano County Accreditation Card bearing the date of issuance, date of expiration, and the signature of the EMS Agency Medical Director.
8. The EMS Agency shall notify individuals applying for accreditation of the decision to accredit within ten (10) working days of completion of the above requirements.
9. Every attempt will be made to mail the Solano County Accreditation Card to the applicant within ten (10) working days of completion of the above requirements.
- E. Paramedics Employed by Solano County EMS Agency
 1. Paramedics that are employed by the Solano County EMS Agency are eligible for initial Solano County Paramedic Accreditation so long as requirements of Section I(A)(1), (3), and (4)(a) of this policy are met. All other accreditation requirements may be waived at the discretion of the EMS Agency Medical Director.

II. MAINTAINING ACCREDITATION

- A. Requirements to maintain accreditation:
 1. Maintenance of a valid State of California Paramedic license;
 2. Maintenance of a valid, current certification card in the following:
 - a. BLS CPR for Healthcare Provider or equivalent; **and**
 - b. ACLS card issued in accordance with the guidelines of the Journal of the American Medical Association; **and**
 - c. PALS **or** PEPP; **and**
 - d. PHTLS **or** BTLS OR ITLS
 3. Employment with an authorized ALS Provider or volunteer fire department within Solano County;

4. Compliance with the following requirements:

- a. Completion of four (4) hours Advanced/Difficult Airway Management Course and manipulative skills as specified in Policy 6608.
 - i. If the Advanced/Difficult Airway Management Course is a portion of another Continuing Education (CE) Course, only the hours for Advanced/Difficult Airway Management will be used for reaccreditation and not the total hours of the course.
 - ii. One hour of AHA ACLS may be used to satisfy this requirement.
 - iii. One hour of AHA PALS may be used to satisfy this requirement.
- b. Paramedics may, at the discretion of the EMS Agency Medical Director, be required to:
 - i. Complete training courses on revised policies and procedures, treatment protocols, and/or optional scopes of practice.
 - ii. Obtain education aimed at specific clinical conditions or problems identified in the quality improvement program, which may include specialized training or certification in pre-established courses.
 - iii. Demonstrate competency of infrequently used skills.
- e. All required reaccreditation documentation shall be turned into Solano County EMS 30 days prior to the current accreditation expiration date to allow adequate time for processing.
 - i. Failure to turn in reaccreditation documentation 30 days prior to the current accreditation expiration will result in a late fee as set forth in Solano County EMS Policy 3000. Reaccreditation will not be processed until the late fee is received.

B. Paramedics Employed by Solano County EMS Agency

1. Paramedics that are employed by the Solano County EMS Agency are eligible for Solano County Paramedic Reaccreditation provided the requirements of Section II(A)(1), (2), and (4) of this policy are met. All other reaccreditation requirements may be waived at the discretion of the EMS Agency Medical Director.

III. ADVERSE ACTIONS ON ACCREDITATION

- A. Accreditation may be denied or suspended by the Solano County EMS Agency for cause.
- B. If a Paramedic does not meet ALL local reaccreditation requirements by close of business (5:00pm) on the date of accreditation expiration, the Paramedic's accreditation will be considered expired and therefore Paramedic accreditation will be suspended.
 1. If the Paramedic accreditation is set to expire on a weekend or holiday, all reaccreditation documentation shall be submitted by close of business (5:00pm) on the Friday prior to the weekend or the day prior to the holiday or the reaccreditation will be considered expired.
 2. If the EMS Agency has not received the Paramedic's completed reaccreditation documentation by 2:00pm on the day of, Friday prior to the weekend, or day prior

to the holiday of expiration, a letter of eminent suspension will be sent to the Paramedic.

- C. Suspension of accreditation means that the Paramedic cannot work as a Paramedic in Solano County. If a Paramedic's accreditation is suspended, a letter explaining the circumstances will be sent to the Paramedic. Copies of this letter may also be sent to all EMS Agency staff, the Paramedic's immediate supervisor/employer, and the California State EMS Authority.
- D. If a California State Licensed Paramedic allows their Solano County Paramedic accreditation to lapse, Paramedic accreditation may be reinstated if ALL requirements for reaccreditation are met **AND** the appropriate late and reinstatement fees as stated in Policy 3000 are paid within 60 days of expiration.
- E. If a California State Licensed Paramedic allows their Paramedic accreditation to lapse for longer than 60 days, the California State Licensed Paramedic will be required to perform the initial requirements for Solano County Paramedic Accreditation.
- F. Accreditation will not be denied based on a Paramedic's accreditation history with another EMS Agency or their provider affiliation.
- G. Any circumstances and actions against a Paramedic's accreditation may be forwarded to the California State EMS Authority for further investigation and Paramedic Licensure action.

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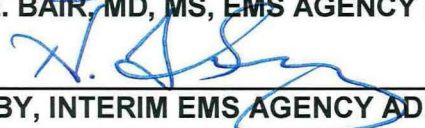
POLICY MEMORANDUM 3405

Implementation Date: August 11, 2015

Release Date: June 26, 2015

REVIEWED/APPROVED BY:


AARON E. BAIR, MD, MS, EMS AGENCY MEDICAL DIRECTOR


TED SELBY, INTERIM EMS AGENCY ADMINISTRATOR

SUBJECT: COMMUNITY PARAMEDICINE

AUTHORITY: California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4; California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 7, Chapter 6; Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, Chapter 2, Section 1797.52, and Chapter 4, Section 1797.218; Health and Safety Code, Division 107, part 3, Chapter 3, Article 1, commencing with Section 128125, the Health Workforce Pilot Projects Program; California Office of Statewide Health Planning and Development (OSHPD) Health Workforce Pilot Projects Program (HWPP) – Program Approval #173

I. PURPOSE/POLICY:

To provide a mechanism for vulnerable populations to access post hospital discharge follow up, treatment, and referral of patients with a confirmed diagnosis of Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD), Congestive Heart Failure (CHF), or at risk for medical noncompliance or rapid decompensation.

II. COMMUNITY PARAMEDIC SELECTION CRITERIA:

- A. In order to be eligible to be trained as a Community Paramedic (CP), under the Health Workforce Pilot Projects Program – Program approval #173, the incumbent must meet minimum qualifications, to include:
1. 4 years experience as a Paramedic;
 2. 2 years experience in Solano County;
 3. Apply to and be selected by the Community Paramedic Steering Committee;
 4. Written recommendation from Medic Ambulance Quality Assurance/Improvement Department;
 5. Written recommendation from Medic's Medical Director, or the Solano County EMS Agency's Medical Director;
- (The ultimate decision to accept a CP or CP Supervisor is with Medic Ambulance Administration and Medical Director.)

- B. In order to be eligible to be trained as a Community Paramedic Supervisor, under the Health Workforce Pilot Projects Program – Program approval #173, the incumbent must meet minimum qualifications, to include:
1. 8 years experience as a Paramedic
 2. 2 years experience in Solano County;
 3. Apply to and be selected by the Community Paramedic Steering Committee.
 4. Written recommendation from Medic Ambulance Quality Assurance/Improvement Department;
 5. Written recommendation from Medic's Medical Director, or the Solano County EMS Agency's Medical Director.

(The ultimate decision to accept a CP Supervisor is with Medic Ambulance Administration and Medical Director.)

III. PATIENT INCLUSION CRITERIA:

- A. Patients must meet the following criteria for inclusion in the Medic CP Pilot Project:
1. Confirmed Diagnosis of COPD, CHF, or other condition mutually agreed upon by Medic, Primary Care Provider (PCP), and Patient.
 2. Discharged home from Kaiser Vallejo, Kaiser Vacaville, or NorthBay/VacaValley Hospital.
 3. Patient is capable of agreeing to participate in the pilot project and complete an OSHPD/HWPP required pilot project informed consent form. Informed consent must be obtained by the CP from the patient at each encounter.
 4. Not enrolled in Hospice.
 5. Not enrolled in any Psychiatric Program designed for the Severely Mentally Ill.
 6. At least 18 years of age and capable of providing consent. (Exceptions for minors may be made on a case by case basis.)

IV. PROCEDURES:

- A. Patients, or their medical decision maker, who meet the inclusion criteria will be contacted by the participating Facility (Kaiser Vacaville or Kaiser Vallejo or NorthBay Medical Center) prior to hospital discharge to explain the purpose and benefits of the Community Paramedicine Pilot Project. The patient will then be consented for pilot project participation. This initial informed consent will only apply to the initial Community Paramedic (CP) telephone contact described below. Further patient encounters by CP personnel will require a separate informed consent. Patients may withdraw consent in the pilot project at any time.
- B. Patients who agree to participate in the pilot project will be approved by the participating facility which will enroll the patient into the CP Program. The Facility representative will contact Medic Dispatch and setup the initial encounter through dispatch. The Medic CP Coordinator will collect all patient demographics, histories, and orders from the Facility. Once all pertinent information is obtained the CP visit will be scheduled.
- C. Patient will be contacted by Medic CP personnel via telephone between six and 24 hours of hospital discharge. An approved standard script will be utilized by the CP representative for these initial patient contacts.
- D. The CP representative will utilize an approved algorithm to assess the patient and will take the following actions based on their assessment and patient needs:
 - 1. Ensure the patient has a clear understanding of their hospital discharge instructions. If the patient's understanding of their hospital discharge instructions is unclear, the CP will take one or more of the following actions:
 - a. Perform a home assessment to allow for further assessment.
 - b. Contact the Facility for clarification and direction.
 - c. Contact or refer the patient to their primary care provider (PCP) for clarification and direction.
 - 2. Assist the patient with scheduling or referral to their PCP.
 - 3. Assess the need for transportation and, if necessary, assist the patient in one or more of the following ways:
 - a. Arrange transportation via taxi.
 - b. Arrange a non-medical transport.
 - c. Make a referral to case management.
 - 4. Medication reconciliation to ensure that the patient has obtained, and is taking, their medications as prescribed. The CP will attempt to resolve any minor identified medication issues with the patient. If the CP identifies any medication issues that they are unable to resolve over the telephone, the CP will take one or more of the following actions:

- a. Perform a home visit to allow for further assessment.
 - b. Referral to case management.
 - c. Contact or refer the patient to their PCP for clarification and direction.
5. Complete Integral Triage Assessment Questionnaire.
6. Assist in assessing the accuracy and completion of the Physician Orders for Life-Sustaining Treatment (POLST) Form.
7. The CP, patient, or the patient's medical decision maker, and responsible parties at the Facility will all complete satisfaction surveys on all enrolled patients.

V. ADVERSE REACTIONS:

1. The following circumstances identify an adverse reaction:
 - Any situation that has potential to adversely affect a patient.
 - A conflict exists with a county policy/protocol or state law, or a patient's condition that warrants deviation from protocol (i.e. requiring Base Physician's order).
 - A significant threat or barrier to the delivery of high quality patient care.
 - A threat to the safety of patients or community paramedics.
2. In the event of an adverse reaction one or more of the following actions will be implemented:
 - a. The CP will notify the CP Supervisor(s) immediately.
 - b. Within 24 hours a Field Advisory Report (FAR) will be filled out and submitted to the EMS Agency.
 - c. The CP will make contact with the PCP for direction and referral.
 - d. The patient may be dis-enrolled from the Program.
 - e. Law enforcement may be notified, unless, contraindicated by patient confidentiality.

VI. DOCUMENTATION:

- A. The CP will utilize a HIPPA compliant electronic medical record system.
- B. All documentation will be reviewed and audited by Medic's Quality Assurance section.
- C. Quality Assurance information will be evaluated by Solano County EMS Agency and partner hospitals.

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GERALD HUBER
Director

EMERGENCY SERVICES BUREAU
355 Tuolumne Street,
Suite 2400, MS 20-240
Vallejo, CA 94590

DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & SOCIAL SERVICES
Public Health Division



**SOLANO
COUNTY**

PRANAV SHETTY, MD, MPH
EMS Agency Medical Director

BENJAMIN GAMMON, EMT-P
Interim EMS Agency Administrator

(707) 784-8155
www.solanocounty.com

POLICY MEMORANDUM 3420

Implementation Date: August 1, 1991

Revised Date: August 1, 2022

Review Date: August 1, 2024

REVIEWED/APPROVED BY:

A blue ink signature of Pranav Shetty, MD, MPH.

PRANAV SHETTY, MD, MPH, EMS AGENCY MEDICAL DIRECTOR

A blue ink signature of Benjamin Gammon, EMT-P.

BENJAMIN GAMMON, EMT-P, INTERIM EMS AGENCY ADMINISTRATOR

SUBJECT: PARAMEDIC PRECEPTOR – ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

AUTHORITY: HEALTH AND SAFETY CODE, DIVISION 2.5, SECTION 1797.220 and
CALIFORNIA CODE OF REGULATIONS, TITLE 22, DIVISION 9, ARTICLE 2,
CHAPTER 4, SECTION 100150.

PURPOSE/POLICY:

To establish a means for designating Paramedic Preceptors and criteria for evaluation of interns, candidates, and paramedics that require monitoring.

I. ROLE OF PARAMEDIC PRECEPTOR

- A. Solano County Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Agency shall designate Paramedics as preceptors who shall monitor and evaluate:
 - 1. The performance of Paramedic students performing internship requirements of their Paramedic program.
 - 2. Paramedics undergoing pre-accreditation evaluation to be able to become a Solano County Accredited Paramedic.
 - 3. Solano County Accredited Paramedics identified by the Quality Assurance (QA) process as needing in-service education and/or probationary monitoring as required by the EMS Agency Medical Director.
- B. Solano County Advanced Life Support (ALS) Providers may elect Paramedics employed by them to become Designated Paramedic Preceptors following the steps outlined in Section II of this policy.

- C. Upon the implementation of this policy, all current Designated Paramedic Preceptors will keep their status, with tier requirements removed, until the expiration of their current Solano County EMS Paramedic Accreditation.

II. PREREQUISITES FOR DESIGNATION OF PRECEPTOR

- A. Paramedic must be currently accredited in Solano County as a Paramedic and be in good standing with Advanced Life Support (ALS) Provider and EMS Agency current audit review mechanisms;
- B. Paramedic shall demonstrate field experience in Solano County as an Accredited Paramedic for at least two (2) years **OR** one (1) year as a paramedic in another 9-1-1 system and one (1) year in Solano County;
- C. Paramedic must have a course completion certificate for a basic Preceptor Training Workshop from a preceptor program approved by Solano County EMS within the last three months;
- D. Paramedic must have a written recommendation from his/her employer. This letter will be an attestation to speak of the Paramedic's abilities, knowledge, potential leadership skills, and they meet the above requirements. This letter will be submitted by the ALS Provider.

III. DESIGNATION

- A. After approval of all required documentation, applicants shall be granted Paramedic Preceptor Status by the Solano County EMS Agency for a period that runs concurrent with their Solano County Paramedic Accreditation.
- B. Preceptor status may be revoked by the EMS Medical Director at any time, after formally reviewing a written request from Base Hospital Liaison personnel, training institutes, ALS Providers, Physician's Forum, EMS Agency Staff, the Preceptor, or after review of the annual Designated Paramedic Preceptor Quality Improvement Review.
- C. Revocation of Paramedic Preceptor status shall follow due process, to include:
 - 1. Revocation recommendation with reason for revocation clearly identified by the petitioner, AND
 - 2. Preceptor interview with final outcome status to be under the purview of the EMS Agency Medical Director.

IV. REDESIGNATION

- A. A Designated Paramedic Preceptor may redesignate by completing a Renewal Paramedic Preceptor Redesignation Application (Attachment A) when reaccrediting as a Paramedic for Solano County as outlined in Policy 3400, Paramedic Accreditation/Reaccreditation Process Section II.
 - 1. If a Paramedic fails to meet the Paramedic reaccreditation criteria and Paramedic accreditation expires, the Paramedic's Preceptor Designation shall be forfeited and the Paramedic must reapply for Preceptor Designation using the initial designation process.

- B. An approved Paramedic Preceptor shall perform preceptor duties for at least one (1) Paramedic (accrediting Paramedic or Paramedic under review) or a paramedic student OR be a lead instructor for an EMS related educational endeavor per two-year period. The names of Paramedics or paramedic students and time periods of monitoring or name of educational endeavor shall be documented on the renewal application.
 - 1. If a Paramedic Preceptor is unable to perform instructional duties for at least one Paramedic (accrediting Paramedic or Paramedic under review) or a paramedic student or be lead instructor per two-year period, the Paramedic Preceptor shall do the following:
 - a. Submit a Renewal Paramedic Preceptor Redesignation Application (Attachment A) as outlined in Section (IV)(A) of this policy; AND
 - b. Retake a Preceptor Training Workshop from a preceptor program approved by Solano County EMS
- C. By not filing this application, the Paramedic Preceptor will forfeit Paramedic Preceptor Designation. The former Paramedic Preceptor may reapply at a later time using the initial designation process.
- D. A Designated Paramedic Preceptor may voluntarily request at any time to surrender his/her designation status. This request shall be submitted in writing to the EMS Agency and the Paramedic Preceptor's employer will be notified.
- E. For any reason, if an ALS Provider removes Designated Paramedic Preceptor status from a preceptor, the ALS Provider shall notify Solano County EMS Agency and provide written documentation and supporting evidence as to why this is occurring.

V. DESIGNATED PARAMEDIC PRECEPTOR QUALITY IMPROVEMENT REVIEW

- A. The ALS Provider shall conduct a quality improvement review annually including a critique of each Paramedic Preceptor's activities during the preceding year with special attention to:
 - 1. Review of all audits completed involving Paramedic Preceptor being reviewed;
 - 2. Review of all counseling sessions documented;
 - 3. Review of any Field Advisory Reports;
- B. The ALS Provider, after the annual Preceptor review, shall provide a summary of findings to Solano County EMS Agency. This summary is to include, but not be limited to:
 - 1. Number of times Preceptors were used and how many Paramedic field interns or Accrediting Paramedics each Paramedic Preceptor had in the preceding year;
 - 2. A sampling of feedback from Paramedic field interns and Accrediting Paramedics on each Paramedic Preceptor;
 - 3. Any issues with patient care witnessed by Paramedic Preceptors by the Paramedics being precepted;
 - 4. Any Field Advisory Reports (FAR) involving the Paramedic Preceptor;
 - 5. Any action taken against the Paramedic Preceptor by the ALS Provider.

- C. Any adverse action reported to the Solano County EMS Agency stemming from the Preceptor annual review may affect the Paramedic's Designated Preceptor status, including but not limited to: reeducation, suspension of the Preceptor Designation, and/or notification of action to the California State EMS Authority for further investigation.

VI. DOCUMENTATION

- A. Documentation of performance for Paramedic field interns shall be recorded on forms provided by the Paramedic training institutes and approved by Solano County.
- B. Documentation of performance for Paramedics awaiting accreditation, or probationary Paramedics, shall be recorded on Solano County Paramedic Performance Evaluation Form.
- C. Patient Care Reports (PCR) shall be utilized, as set forth in Solano County Policy 6100, Instructions for Completion of Patient Care Record. Both the Paramedic Preceptor and/or the Paramedic field intern shall sign and review the PCR prior to submission at the receiving hospital.
- D. Skills verification reports generated and documented through Electronic PCRs will be made available upon written request by the Paramedic Trainee. These will be mailed directly to the Training Instructor responsible for the requesting Paramedic field intern within 60 days of completion of the Paramedic Field Internship.

VII. RESPONSIBILITY OF THE PARAMEDIC PRECEPTOR

- A. It shall be the responsibility of the Paramedic Preceptor to allow or disallow patient contact and EMS intervention based on his/her perceptions as to the ability of the Paramedic (accrediting Paramedic or Paramedic under review) or paramedic student. The health and safety of the patient is always the paramount issue.
 - 1. If an incident should occur while performing patient care, the Paramedic Preceptor, as well as the Paramedic (accrediting Paramedic or Paramedic under review) or paramedic student, shall be reviewed under the QI processes of the ALS Provider Agency and the EMS Agency. The EMS Agency shall be notified of an incident through the FAR process within 48 hours of the incident.
 - a. If a paramedic student is involved with the incident, the paramedic student's Instructional Institution shall be notified of the incident for possible reeducation.

VIII. MINIMUM NUMBER OF PARAMEDIC PRECEPTORS PER PROVIDER SERVICE

- A. Each provider service shall maintain a minimum of one (1) Paramedic Preceptor for every ten (10) Paramedics employed to adequately provide for Paramedic preceptor responsibilities.
- B. ALS Providers shall submit to Solano County EMS Agency a list of active/approved Paramedic Preceptors annually, or upon request.
 - 1. Failure by the ALS Provider to submit a list of active/approved Paramedic Preceptors may result in the suspension of **ALL** Paramedic Preceptors until this documentation is received.

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Solano County Health & Social Services Department



Gerald Huber, Director

Aaron E. Bair, MD, MS
EMS Agency Medical Director

EMERGENCY SERVICES BUREAU
355 Tuolumne Street MS 20-240, Suite 2400
Vallejo, Ca. 94590
(707) 784-8155
www.solanocounty.com

Ted Selby
EMS Agency Administrator

POLICY 3420 ATTACHMENT A INITIAL PARAMEDIC PRECEPTOR APPLICATION

FOR _____ **through** _____
(Start date) (Accreditation expiration date)

NAME: _____

SOLANO COUNTY PARAMEDIC #: _____

DATE: _____

EMPLOYER: _____

Years as an Accredited Paramedic in Solano County: _____

Preceptor Tier Level Applying For: ☐ TIER I ☐ TIER II

Checklist for required preceptor prerequisite documentation:

- ☐ Verification of Solano County Paramedic accreditation in good standing **AND** years of service within Solano County in accordance of Tier Level applying for;
- ☐ For Tier II ONLY: Documentation of successful completion of any formal adult education training programs (AHA certified instructor, teaching credentials, transcripts, Fire Instructor 1A and 1B, etc.);
- ☐ Written recommendations from my employer **AND** ALS Provider Medical Director;
- ☐ Written verification of course completion of a Paramedic Preceptor Training Workshop or equivalent within the last three months as approved by the EMS Agency Medical Director.

I hereby attest that all statements above and attachments are true.

Applicant Signature

GERALD HUBER
Director

EMERGENCY SERVICES BUREAU
355 Tuolumne Street,
Suite 2400, MS 20-240
Vallejo, CA 94590

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www.solanocounty.com

**POLICY 3420 ATTACHMENT A
PARAMEDIC PRECEPTOR APPLICATION RENEWAL**

FOR: _____ **through** _____
(Start date) (Accreditation expiration date)

DATE: _____

NAME: _____

CALIFORNIA STATE PARAMEDIC LICENSE #: _____

SOLANO COUNTY PARAMEDIC #: _____

EMPLOYER: _____

Years as an accredited Paramedic in Solano County: _____

Years as a Designated Paramedic Preceptor in Solano County: _____

Name of Paramedics/Paramedic Interns Precepted OR EMS Instruction	Dates Precepted or Instructed

*If more room is needed, continue on the back of this application.

I hereby attest that all statements above are true.

Applicant Signature